

Syllabus and Assessment

EART60071 Measuring and Predicting 2

Syllabus

Academic year: 2026–2027. Semester 1; 15 credits.

Activity	Time and location
Lectures	Fridays, 09:00–11:00; Schuster, Blackett Theatre.
Practicals	Fridays, 12:00–15:00; Nancy Rothwell, 1A 044 (Computer cluster 3).

Programme information

Core module for:

- MPEC;
- MESPOM.

Optional for: N/A.

Instructor

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[Staff profile](#)

Assessment

Assessment	Weighting
Formative online assessment - released towards the end of the course	0%
Summative online assessment - available 14–29 January 2027	100%

Computing and course material

The module is taught face-to-face and the practicals use hands-on environmental modelling. The *Tools of the Trade* handout explains the course Linux-server workflow, including Windows and macOS access, secure file transfer and optional Docker use for local work.

[Module webpage](#). Canvas is the authoritative location for assessment links, server login details, announcements and updated instructions.

Attendance, practice and feedback

Attendance at timetabled teaching and practical activities is expected. Feedback is available through discussion in class, by working through practical results and model output, and through class discussion of issues that arise in the assessments.

The questions in the *Pressure, Temperature, Humidity, Visibility and Particulate* and *Dynamical Models* chapters are intended as practice. Work through them yourself before looking at the worked answers; use the answers to identify anything you need to revisit or ask about in class.

Assessment details

The module has one summative online assessment worth 100% of the module mark. A formative assessment is provided beforehand so that you can practise the same style of questions and identify topics to revisit before the January assessment.

Formative online assessment - practice (0%)

Released towards the end of the course on Canvas. It has the **same format as the final assessment: 10 questions**. It does not contribute to your module mark and you may take it **as many times as you like**.

The formative assessment is there to be used, rather than simply completed once. It will provide feedback after an attempt, so use that feedback to decide what to practise next. For questions you find difficult, return to the relevant lecture notes, chapter questions and practical work, then try the formative assessment again.

There will also be time to discuss the formative assessment and get feedback in class before Christmas. If you are able to complete an attempt before then, bring questions about anything you did not understand so that we can work through the reasoning together. The exact release date and any updated instructions will be given on Canvas.

Summative online assessment - 100%

Assessment window: 14–29 January 2027. The assessment contains **10 questions** on Canvas and follows the same format as the formative assessment. Check Canvas for the exact opening and closing times and any final instructions.

Questions may draw on material from across the module, including the models used, the assumptions behind them, and the interpretation of practical results. Preparation should therefore involve doing calculations and explaining reasoning, not just rereading notes.

How to prepare effectively

- Work through the questions in the *Pressure, Temperature, Humidity, Visibility and Particulate* and *Dynamical Models* chapters without looking at the worked answers first. Then check your method as well as your final number.
- Revisit practical exercises and make sure you understand what each model calculates, the important inputs and assumptions, and what the output means physically.
- Use the formative assessment more than once if useful. A better second attempt after revising a weak topic is more valuable than repeatedly clicking through the same answers.
- If you can get as far as explaining *why* an answer is right, rather than only recognising the correct option, you are preparing at the right level.